

HDQRS. CAVALRY CORPS, ARMY OF THE POTOMAC,
Todd's Tavern, May 7, 1864—8 p. m.

GENERAL: The cavalry made a very handsome fight here this afternoon. We found the whole rebel cavalry here, Hampton's and Fitzhugh Lee's divisions, and drove them on the Spotsylvania road about 3 miles. They were very handsomely repulsed, and drove on the road to Beech Grove Church. They had constructed barricades and rifle-pits, which we charged and captured. I had only four brigades engaged—Merritt's, Davies', Colonel Gregg's, and Colonel Devin's. They all behaved splendidly. I captured prisoners from Lomax's, Wickham's, Rosser's, Young's, Gordon's, and Chambliss' brigades, and killed Colonel Collins, of the Fifteenth Virginia Cavalry.

I am, very respectfully, your obedient servant,
 P. H. SHERIDAN,
Major-General, Commanding.

Major-General HUMPHREYS,
Chief of Staff.

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HEADQUARTERS ARMY OF THE POTOMAC,
May 12, 1864. (Received 7.20 p. m.)

Maj. Gen. H. W. HALLECK,
Chief of Staff:

The following dispatch just received:

HEADQUARTERS CAVALRY CORPS,
May 10, 1864.

Maj. Gen. GEORGE G. MEADE,
Commanding Army of the Potomac:

GENERAL: I turned the enemy's right and got into their rear. Did not meet sufficient of cavalry to stop me. Destroyed from 8 to 10 miles of Orange railroad, two locomotives, three trains, and a very large amount of supplies. The enemy were making a depot of supplies at Beaver Dam. Since I got into their rear there has been great excitement among the inhabitants and with the army. The citizens report that Lee is beaten. Their cavalry has attempted to annoy my rear and flank, but have been run off. I expect to fight their cavalry south of South Anna River. I have no forage. Started with half rations for one day, and have found none yet. Have recaptured 500 of our men; 2 colonels.

I am, general, very respectfully, your obedient servant,
 P. H. SHERIDAN,
Major-General.

U. S. GRANT,
Lieutenant-General.

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BOTTOM'S BRIDGE, VA., *May 13, 1864.*
(Via Jamestown Island, 11 p. m., 14th.)

GENERAL: I have the honor to report that at 5 a. m. on the 9th instant I marched my command to Tabernacle Church to carry out your instructions. On examination I found that all the forage on hand with the command was half-rations for one day. I therefore determined at once to march around the enemy's right flank, gain the North Anna, and, if possible, the South Anna, before giving the enemy's cavalry battle, as I thought that at either of those points I

should be able to obtain forage for my animals. On the evening of the 9th I reached the North Anna without serious opposition from the enemy. During that night I destroyed the depot at Beaver Dam, 3 large trains of cars, and 100 cars, 2 fine locomotives, 200,000 pounds of bacon and other stores, amounting in all to 1,500,000 of rebel rations; and also the telegraph wire and railroad track for a distance of about 10 miles, embracing several culverts; recaptured 378 of our men, including 2 colonels, 1 major, and several other officers. On the morning of the 10th I resumed the march, crossing the South Anna at Ground Squirrel Bridge, and went into camp about daylight on the 11th. I captured Ashland Station. At this point I destroyed 1 locomotive and a train of cars, engine-house, 2 or 3 Government buildings, containing large amounts of stores; also destroyed 6 miles of railroad, embracing 6 culverts, 2 trestle bridges, and the telegraph wire for some distance. About 7 a. m. on the 11th I resumed the march on Richmond. All the information that could be obtained led me to believe that the rebel General Stuart was concentrating his cavalry at Yellow Tavern. On reaching that point I found such to be the case. I immediately attacked him, and after an obstinate contest I gained possession of the Brook turnpike, captured two pieces of artillery, driving his force back toward Ashland and across the north fork of the Chickahominy, a distance of about 4 miles. At the same time a party charged down the Brook road, across the Chickahominy, and captured the first line of the enemy's works around Richmond. During the night I marched via Brook road, and massed the whole of my command between the first and second lines of the enemy's works on the bluffs overlooking the line of the Virginia Central Railroad and the Mechanicsville pike, my intention being to obtain the enemy's works commanding the Mechanicsville pike, then to pass down the south side of the Chickahominy to the old Fair Oaks battle-ground, and there go into camp. After demonstrating upon the works I found them very strong, and gave up the intention of assaulting. I then determined to recross the Chickahominy at Meadow Bridge, which had been partially destroyed by the enemy. In the course of about three hours the bridge was repaired, under a heavy artillery fire from a battery belonging to the rebel cavalry. This cavalry and artillery were posted across the north end of Meadow Bridge to oppose my recrossing. I directed General Merritt, commanding First Division, to make the crossing, attack the enemy, and drive him off. This was handsomely done, the pursuit continuing as far as Gaines' Mill. During this same time the enemy, observing that I was recrossing the Chickahominy, marched out from his second line of works a brigade of infantry and a large number of dismounted cavalry, and attacked the divisions of Generals Gregg and Wilson. After a severe contest he was repulsed and driven behind his works. These divisions (Gregg's and Wilson's), after collecting the wounded, recrossed the Chickahominy without being followed up. On the afternoon of the 12th the corps encamped at Walnut Grove and Gaines' Mill. At 9 a. m. of the 13th (to-day) resumed the march, and encamped at Bottom's Bridge. I will here cross the Chickahominy, and comply, if possible, with the last condition of my orders. My command is in fine spirits with its success. I have been enabled to bring along with me all of the wounded, excepting about 30 cases of mortal wounds. These were, however, well cared for, and made as comfortable as possible in the farm-houses in the

country. My wounded, I think, will not exceed 250; total losses not over 350. The Virginia Central Railroad bridge over the Chickahominy, and other trestle bridges, one 60, one 30, one 20 feet, and railroad for a long distance north and south of the Chickahominy crossing, were destroyed. My horses are very much jaded for want of forage. My loss in them, however, up to the present time will not exceed 100.

I am very much indebted to Generals Gregg, Wilson, and Merritt, division commanders, and Generals Custer and Davies, and Colonels Gregg, Devin, Chapman, McIntosh, and Gibbs, brigade commanders. Their services are worthy of the very highest praise. All the officers and men of the command behaved splendidly. It is possible that I might have captured the city of Richmond by an assault, but the want of knowledge of your operations and those of General Butler, and the facility with which the enemy could throw in troops, made me abandon the attempt.

I have the honor to be, general, yours, respectfully,

P. H. SHERIDAN,
Major-General, Commanding.

Major-General MEADE,
Commanding Army of the Potomac.

HEADQUARTERS CAVALRY CORPS,
Haxall's Landing, James River, May 14, 1864.

GENERAL: I have the honor to report the arrival of my command at this point. The rebel cavalry are very much demoralized since the fights at Yellow Tavern and Meadow Bridge. I encamped at Walnut Grove from 2 o'clock of the 12th till 9 o'clock of the 13th awaiting an attack, but the enemy did not come on. I could not hunt him up, as my horses have been living on grass nearly all the time since I left, and were too weak and jaded. Major-General Stuart was badly wounded at Yellow Tavern, and Colonel Pate killed. The loss of the enemy at both Yellow Tavern and Meadow Bridge was very severe. I find that my command was attacked, while inside of the intrenchments at Richmond, by two brigades of infantry, and the men feel greatly elated at driving them back behind their works. We remained inside the intrenchments from 9 p. m. of the 11th till 3 p. m. of the next day, and then whipped the enemy's cavalry and infantry. The country passed through by my command is entirely destitute; there is nothing for man or animals. All the country north of the James River is in this condition from very best information. It will take me several days to get my command in condition for effective service. I have taken the greatest care of the horses; in fact I have made regular marches, encamping every night, grazing the animals, and collecting supplies for the men. Only three days' rations were taken by the command. This has lasted six days. If I could be permitted to cross the James River and go southward I could almost ruin the Confederacy. I forward this by Lieutenant-Colonel Kingsbury, my adjutant-general, who can give you many particulars, which will be given in my detailed report. Every exertion will be made to get the command in condition as soon as possible. I am sending my prisoners—between 200 and 300—and my wounded by boat to-night.